1. One of the major problems today is food wastage. It is estimated that 30 percent of all the food produced around the world is lost, **trashed** or otherwise wasted every year. These **statistics** are **staggering**, especially when you consider how many people around the world need that food to survive.

2. A restaurant owner, Minu Pauline of Kochi, had a solution after seeing a hungry woman pick through trash one night. She decided to donate her restaurant's left over food to the hungry. This **initiative** of hers soon became a major **city-wide** campaign. Pauline stored the café's eats in a refrigerator outside her Kochi restaurant. Soon her small "left overs" refrigerator turned to a large scale donation centre with food from her kitchen and those of other restaurants nearby. Even other citizens donated food to this food bank as a way of helping out. It is open 24 hours a day and is never **surveilled**, allowing those in need to maintain their **privacy** while collecting donated food.

3. Best of all, the food bank provides food for dozens of locals every night, thereby cutting the food waste among the local restaurants. This has become the best example of civic sense and responsibility in recent times.

Beach clean up

4. We come across a lot of people who take part in community clean-up efforts. But not everyone has the drive to do what a young lawyer and environmentalist in Mumbai recently accomplished.

5. Afroj Shah was shocked by the pollution that he saw at Versova beach – **rotting** garbage. No one could walk along the beach, let alone swim in the water. He decided to protect the environment.

6. Initially Shah and his neighbour, an eighty-four-year-old man, would go out and pick as much trash as they could. After a while, Shah realised that he had to expand his team if he were to make a **dent** in what was essentially an environmental crisis. He began to knock on doors and talk to local residents, explaining the harm caused by marine pollution. His determination inspired a lot of people and soon dozens, hundreds and eventually more than a thousand volunteers from all walks of life pitched in. Clean-ups were ironically called "dates with the ocean", because it was a Herculean task – cleaning the beach in the sweltering sun.

7. This massive undertaking by the Residents Volunteer Organisation is being hailed as the "World's largest beach clean-up effort". After months of toil they picked up tons of trash that had accumulated along the shoreline. They also cleaned fifty two public toilets and planted fifty coconut trees. For his vision and hard work, the UN awarded him the "Champion

12th Communicative English Book.indb 94 02/02/19 5:09 PM